

to sum up the three days of a crazed killing spree by Kasab and his nine fellow terrorists which left 166 people dead, 300 injured and two luxury hotels and a Jewish synagogue completely gutted. Tahaliyani referred to the attack and its perpetrators as "no ordinary criminals but an act of war," while Public Prosecutor Ujjwal Nikam referred to Kasab as "exceptionally depraved and a killing machine bereft of human nature." Indeed, the judgement found Kasab guilty of over 80 counts but the ones that matter are waging war against the Government of India and entering into a conspiracy to wage war against the Government of India.

On judgement day, Kasab was a pale shadow of his usual chirpy self. Dressed in a white kurta-pyjama, Kasab sat in the dock with his head in his hands. From joking with police constables and even the public prosecutor, Kasab seemed oblivious to the gravity of the charges against him and the impending verdict. His insolence forced Tahaliyani to instruct him to maintain decorum in the court several times. All through the 17 months of the trial, Kasab has come up with new antics to delay it, from retracting his confession statement to making wild claims of being an innocent Indian who had been framed in the case, Kasab did all to derail the trial. He showed no signs of remorse or regret at what he had done.

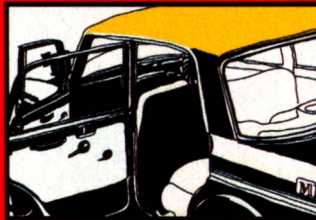
The question before the court was: should Kasab be held responsible for crimes committed by his partners in crime who wreaked havoc in other parts of the city? The judge was of the view that he was part of the entire conspiracy and, therefore, "he is convicted for abetment for other crimes." The judge went on to say: "I have given the finding that these preparations are not made in regular crimes. The resistance showed to the armed forces is an indication of their determination to fight a

THREE HOURS OF INFAMY

For over three hours on 26/11, Kasab and his accomplice Ismail Khan went on a murderous shooting rampage through south Mumbai, indiscriminately killing over 60 people before being overpowered.

2 THE TAXI

Kasab and Khan hire a taxi to CST Railway Station. Kasab plants an 8-kg IED in the car. Terrorists alight at CST. Hours later, taxi explodes at Vile Parle, killing two persons.



3



5 AMBUSHING THE ATS

They ambush a Qualis carrying the ATS top brass, including Hemant Karkare, Ashok Kamte and Vijay Salaskar. They hijack the vehicle, fire at crowds before abandoning it and commandeering a Skoda.



THE NAKABANDI

The duo fire at a police party when stopped at a checkpoint near Chowpatty.



war and not just murder."

Apart from the nine deceased terrorists who accompanied Kasab, the judgement accused 20 other wanted terrorists, including the planners, the

top leadership of the globally outlawed Lashkar-e-Toiba: Hafiz Muhammad Saeed, Zaki-ur-Rehman Lakhvi and Abu Hamza. Surprisingly, the charge-sheet has no mention of David Headley, now in prison in the US and who has confessed to laying the foundation for 26/11 by taking detailed videos of the Taj and Trident/Oberoi hotels where he checked in as a guest, as well as other targets like Chabad House. That, how-

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